



Aarit Kapil of Somerville School, New Delhi, has become one of the youngest players ever to achieve an International Master (IM) norm. At 10 years and seven months, he scored 5/9 with a 2453 performance at the Menorca Open, facing three grandmasters and four IMs, including a win over GM Kazybek Nogerbek. Earlier this year, he became the youngest player to cross the 3000 blitz rating barrier on Chess.com, while last year he held none other than GM Magnus Carlsen to a draw in Chess.com's Titled Tuesday event. Aarit had earlier made waves two years ago when he beat 66-year-old Raset Ziatdinov, becoming the third-youngest player in the world to defeat a grandmaster in classical chess.

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World Under-10 Cadet champion A.S. Sharvaanica stepped up an age category to win the Under-12 title at the FIDE World Rapid Championships with two rounds to spare in Vrnjačka Banja, Serbia.

The 11-round event saw the Woman Candidate Master register 10 wins and a lone draw against Ukraine's Daria Kravchuk.

The 11-year-old sealed the title with a victory over higher-rated Slovenia's Ema Jaksa in the ninth round.

Sharvaanica, a Class V student at Velammal Vidyalaya, Ayanambakkam, drew praise from her school. "The entire Velammal Nexus group is very happy. I extend my congratulations to Sharvaanica for winning the FIDE Cadet Under-12 Rapid Championship.

"Her dedication, focus and perseverance have brought immense pride and honour to the school. She is an inspiration to every

student here," said M.V.M. Velmohan, Correspondent, Velammal Nexus Group of Schools.

Sharvaanica finished with 10.5 points, three clear of WCM Sholpanbek Zhansaya (7.5), to clinch the championship.

Entering the tournament as one of the top seeds with a classical rating of 2041, Sharvaanica began her campaign with a win over Alisa Yunker in Round 3. She followed it up with three successive victories before being held to a draw in Round 7 of the event.

She resumed on the second day with a win over Mariya Shakhova and maintained her momentum to seal the title.

The triumph marks her second World Rapid title. She had earlier won gold in the Under-10 category at the age of nine and also secured a silver medal in the blitz event at the FIDE World Rapid and Blitz Championship in Albania in 2024.